the implementation chapters of the book, we'll focus on pact-js, pact-jvm, the SaaS Pact Broker provided by PactFlow, and the can-i-deploy tool.

A.1.2 Pact Broker

Pact offers an open source broker that can be hosted within your current infrastructure as it comes bundled, as Terraform or inside a Docker container. Alternatively, the software as a service (SaaS) version can be set up and supported by PactFlow (acquired by SmartBear). Setting up the Pact Broker will be discussed further in chapter 7. The broker is the first step to sharing contracts between consumer and provider. The core functionalities supported by the open source broker includes versioning, tagging, and webhooks. The broker also contains the API key and user management for interacting with the broker by users and via continuous integration.

A.1.3 PactFlow

PactFlow offers the SaaS implementation of the Pact Broker on a subscription basis. As well as this it also provides additional features such as single sign-on (SSO) and Bi-directional contract testing support (PDCT). Throughout the book we'll be using PactFlow alongside the code examples to enable readers to get setup quickly. If you're working in a small development team or trialing contract testing I would suggest using the PactFlow to get off the ground. It provides a free five contracts account for exactly this reason.

A.1.4 Pact CLI

Pact CLI is a key part of the Pact ecosystem, integral for publishing contracts and also used to interact with the Pact Broker for contract status. Built into the CLI is the can-i-deploy command which the consumer relies on for status updates on the verification of their contract. This Pact Broker client provides all the commands needed within continuous integration (CI) such as tagging version, environments, and releases.